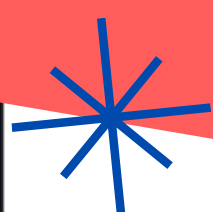


**1-READY
2-SET
3-GO ENTERTAIN !!!**

STEP BY STEP GUIDE
FROM
START TO FINISH



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Disclaimer

The aim of this eBook *"1-Ready, 2-set 3-Go Entertain!!!"* is to bring joy and fun to readers while learning at the same time. The author advises readers to take full responsibility for their safety and know their limits. Before practicing the activities described in this eBook, seek supervision from an adult if needed and do not take risks beyond your level of aptitude and comfort level.

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Intro

Hey Kids.... Do you always have the desire to perform in front of audience while having loads of fun? My sister and I did and so can you! Follow these steps to start your journey of becoming a entertainer!

Hi, my name is Rhett. My sister, T'La, and I have been performing since the age of 10 and 5. We first started by busking on the street, and all we had was a 5min show which consisted of one hula hooping, 2 balls juggling and a little dance duet. We did this over and over for couple of weeks, then we started adding more tricks to our show bit by bit. It just kept growing and we had finally had our 30mins Rhett & Tilly Show, and of course, our first pot of gold!

I have had many young want-to-be performers asking me for advice on how to get started and eventually making money out of it. So I have decided to write this little book to share my tips and experience with all of you.



Follow me on Social Media



Invite parents to join the fun!

To get started, you might need a little bit of help from your parents if you haven't had much earnings.

Just like every other successful businesses, you will need some investors to take care of the fundings while you are there being creative and innovative. So all you have to do, is to invite your parents to invest a little bit of money on few supplies.

To secure the investors' interests, they will, of course, need to monitor or supervise their investment, so get your parents to spend a least one hour on a Saturday or Sunday afternoon to see the progress of your creativity, while spending quality time with their favourite child!

Now don't be scared of failures because practice makes perfect! Do you think Steve Jobs made Apple in just one day? No! It took him years to create his first Apple product, by testings, altering designs and so on. So as long as you don't give up easily, your parents will definitely support you all the way! When you start making money from your creativities, that's when you and your parents (the investors) will get your returns! And by then, you no longer need to pester them for money anymore because you will be able to afford your own supplies! Neat hey?



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Golden Rules

VERY IMPORTANT...

NEVER FORGET THESE 2 GOLDEN RULES OF PERFORMING:

1 - THE CUTE FACTOR

Be as cute as you can, even you boys out there! Who doesn't enjoy watching a cute little performer hitting the stage! That's the advantage of being young, so use it well and start performing! Smile heaps, use make-up to draw attention to your face (if you use a lot of facial expressions). Boys can wear hats and girls can put your hair in piggytails., anything you can think of to enhance the CUTE factor!

2 - KEEP YOUR SHOW SHORT AT FIRST

5mins is all you need to start!! Show off a few tricks that you are confident with, so you can give the best performance to the audience. If you are busking, people are usually on their way to go somewhere, so they'll stay for a minute or two then move on after throwing you a few coins. So at first, you do not need a long show. Yes, it may get boring for you. But remember, your audience changes, so it doesn't matter if you repeat your show. Then as you get better, you can add new things to make your show longer.

Performing teaches important lessons which will benefit you in real life, especially for T'La and I since we started performing, such as:

- self confidence
- confidence in public speaking
- ability to handle and accept feedbacks
- acting skills
- ability to entertain people and make them laugh... and we need more laughter in world.

Getting Started

Watch our YouTube videos to get some ideas on how we started and what you need in your show!

1. Go on **Youtube** and type in "**Rhett Tilly busking 07 - 09**", OR
2. Copy and paste the following link into your browser:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mnisAhsGhvl>

Remember **PRACTICE MAKES PERFECT!!** Watch the below video and see what we are doing today!

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Al-hpfPsbLA&t=8s>

See? Everything starts small. All you need is just a few props, which you might already have in your house, and keep practising and perfecting your show. Then eventually you can add more and more content to your show to make it bigger, just like the snowball effect!

In the next few pages, I will show you how to make your own props. This can be a little project for you and you parents, or you could just buy the props if you wish. Here are some links where you can buy the props online:

<https://www.threeworlds.com.au/>

<https://www.circusshop.com.au/>

<http://www.weirderthebetter.com.au/>

The above websites are some Australian online circus stores, I do not own or have partnerships with them. You can also find few circus equipment like juggling balls, flower sticks and diablo in a local store called Australian Geographic.

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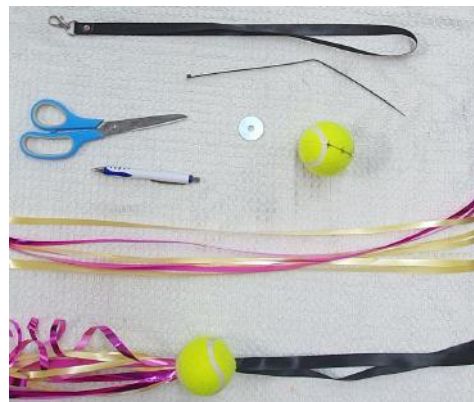


Making Twirling Poi

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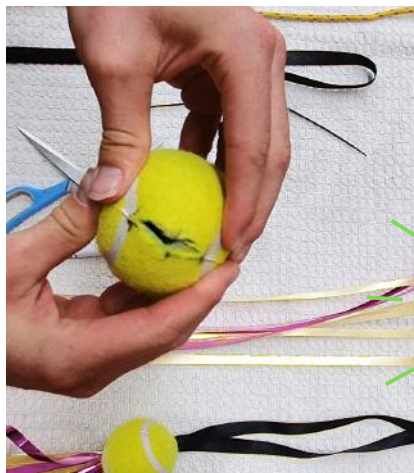
Materials

- 2 x lanyards (can use ropes)
- 2 x tennis balls
- 8 x 1m strips of colorful ribbon or glittery foil
- 2 x washers



STEP 1

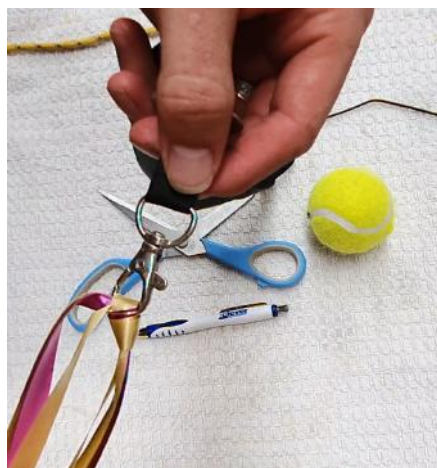
Cut 2 openings in the tennis ball, each directly opposite the other (I highly recommend to ask your parents' help on this). Both openings should be roughly 3-5cm in length, so that it can fit your fingers inside when you squeeze it.



Easy

STEP 2

Tie the centre of all the ribbons to the clip of the lanyard



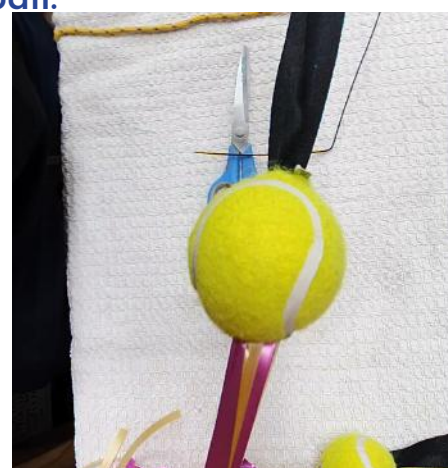
STEP 3

Thread the lanyard through the eye of the washer and push the washer against the clip of the lanyard.



STEP 4

Put the lanyard into one opening of the tennis ball and pull it out from the opposite opening. Make sure the washer stays inside the ball.



Making Juggling Balls

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Making your own juggling balls is quite easy, you can use anything that is a ball shape (e.g. tennis ball, bouncy ball, orange, apple or even eggs if you are brave enough!!!). Make sure you ask your parents before using any of the above objects or they might get upset. If you want to get creative, then this is the way to make your own custom juggling balls.

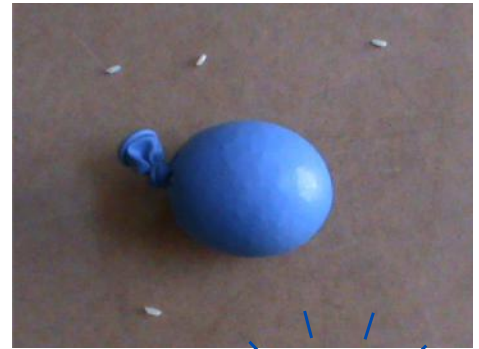
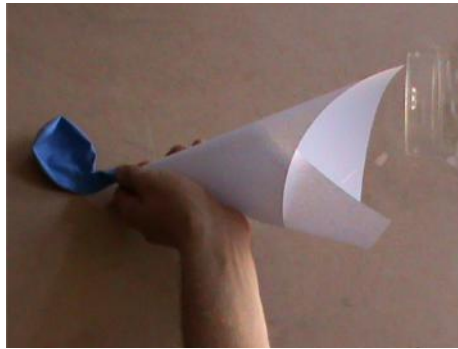
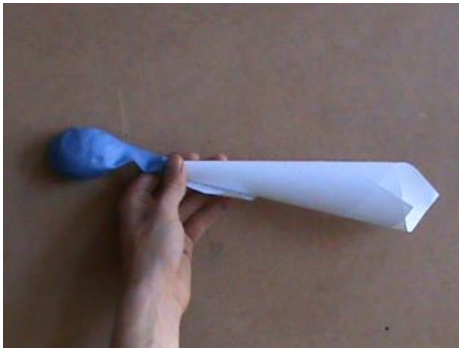
Materials

- Round party balloons
- Rice of any sort
- Nozzle (made from paper)
- Scissors (make sure your parent is with you)



STEP 1

Grab a balloon and put the paper nozzle in its opening. Fill the balloon with rice half way to the top, then tie a knot in the balloon.



STEP 2

Get 3 more balloons (or as many as you like) and cut the necks off. Then cut some holes in the balloons to create your own pattern.



Great Job

STEP 3

Wrap the decorative balloons (the patterned ones) over the balloon that has the rice in it. Repeat Step 1 and 2. until you reach the amount of juggling balls you want. There you have it, your very own design cool juggling balls!



Making Juggling Clubs

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You might have to discuss with your parents before making this prop, as you will need their help in getting or using the tools. I used Coles' Blackcurrant Juice 750mL bottle in this tutorial because it is the perfect shape of a juggling club. But you can also use any 750mL or 1L plastic bottles, they work just as fine!

Materials

- Coles' Blackcurrant Juice 750ml
- 6 x Wood screw
- 1 x Screw driver
- 3 x Piece of dowels 50cmL x 5cmW
- 3 x Door stoppers
- Decorative tapes
- Tennis overgrip tape for padding

Keep
it up



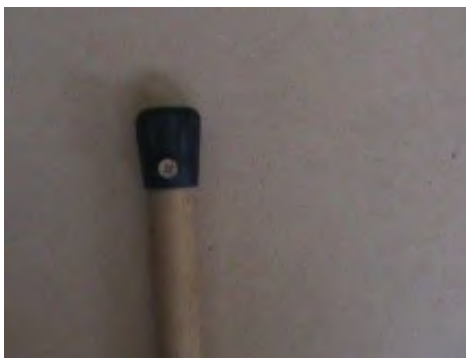
STEP 1

Cut the dowel into the required measurement (50cm long). Get your bottle, put the dowel through the mouth till it touches the bottom of the bottle. Drill the screw from the top of the bottle into the dowel, so it is stable.



STEP 2

Screw the door stopper onto the bottom of the dowel, then use the tennis overgrip tape to wrap the handle. Do it from bottom to top, just like wrapping your tennis racquet, until you hit the wider surface of the bottle. The dowel itself is very rough, so adding the overgrip will give you a good grip and protect your hands. Now the fun part - decorating your juggling club with decorative tapes however you want! If you wish to keep it simple, just stop there and repeat Step 1 & 2.



Making Hula Hoops

Now you boys out there thinking that hoops are just for girls, check out hula hooping on YouTube, there are some amazing male hula hoopists!

You'll need to ask your parents to get you some poly pipe from the hardware store and some small wood dowels. Make sure the diameters of the dowels are small enough to just fit inside the poly pipe, but not too small that leaves too much gap between the pipe. You're going to need a lot of decorative tapes for this project. Or, you always have the option to just buy a hula hoop.

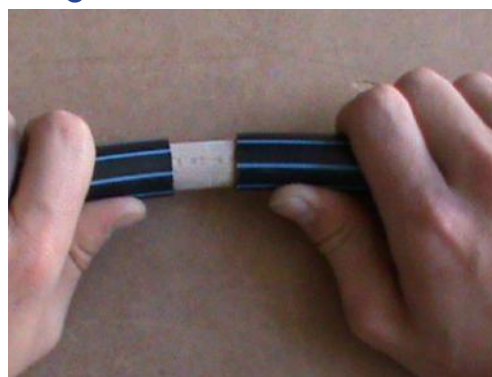
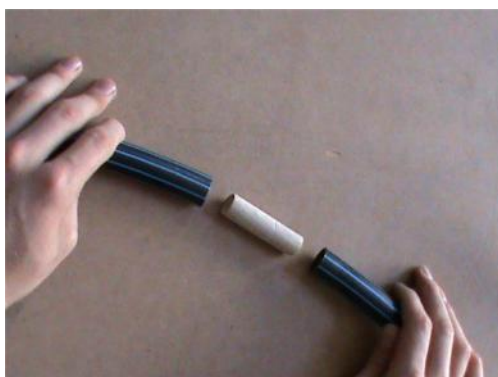
Materials

- Poly pipe
- Small wood dowels
- Decrative tapes



STEP 1

Cut the poly pipe to a size that suits you. A good way to measure is to stand on the poly pipe and make a circle, which the diameter is as high as your hips. Cut the dowel to about to 5cm long.



STEP 2

Put the dowel inside the pipe where the two ends meet and tape it in place. The next step is to decorate the hoop. Pretty simple hey?



***Tips :** Use holographic, electric, craft tapes to make your hoops shine

Making Rolla Bolla

You will need a pipe and wooden board, which you might be able to find in your house or your parents' workshed. Stand on the pipe to see if it can hold your weight. The length of the pipe is roughly the length of your arm. The thicker the wall of the pipe, the stronger it is. I found that sewage pipe is much stronger, so it is better for making Rolla Bolla (if you are able to find them in your house). Otherwise, just any PVC pipe to start off with.

Materials

- 1 x PVC Pipe
- 2 x Wooden Board

Cut the width of the board to about the same length of your feet and make sure it fits comfortably. The length of the board should be little bit bigger then the width of your shoulders. You will probably need your parents' help to cut the board and pipe to the ideal size, but then that's it, your rolla bolla is ready to go! Pretty easy right?



How to balance on the rolla bolla?

Take your rolla bolla, find a fence or a wall anywhere and hold on to it for balance. Place the board on an angel on top of the pipe. Put one foot on the bottom end of the board (where the board touches the ground), and then the other foot gently on the other end. Now you are standing in a tilted position. While balancing on the wall/fence, slowly transfer some weights from one foot to the other, keep your knees bent when balancing, this will help you maintain the centre of gravity in the centre of the rolla bolla. Get your parents to spot you when you attempt this for the first time!



Balloon Twisting Basics

Types of balloon

The most common size of quality twisting balloon used is the **260Q**. Twisting balloons are measured by the inflated size, so the 260 means 2 inches wide in diameter and 60 inches long when fully inflated. Qualatex twisting balloons are preferred by balloon sculptors, like clowns and children party entertainers, because they are more durable and don't pop that easy. Below is a photo of the different sizes of balloon that artists commonly use - 160Q, 260Q, 350Q, 646Q.



Where to get balloon from

You can easily get modelling / twisting balloons from supermarkets, party supplies store like Spotlights, or even some budget variety stores like Stacks and The Reject Shop. You don't need to get the most expensive brands, try out different brands and see which suits you best. Some even have starter kits that include a small balloon pump, which I used to get for practicing when I first started. Once you start making money with it, then you will need to use Qualatex for proper gigs.

You can also buy your balloons online, below is the links to my top 3 online stores:

www.jaztrading.com/

<https://www.balloonguy.com.au> - also know as Jay Jay Balloon guy

<https://www.balloonagencies.com.au/>



Click on logo for more great fun tutorials!!! ➡



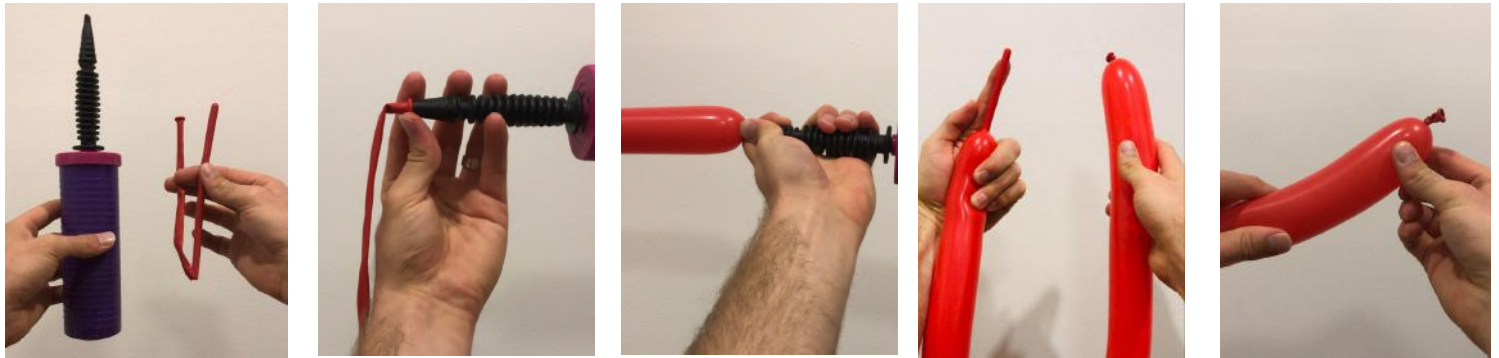
Basic Balloon Twists

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The easiest balloon art will probably be a balloon animal. Making a balloon animal means you have to make bubbles of various sizes and then twist them together in different combinations to create the desired balloon animal. Sort of like a jigsaw puzzle, putting the right pieces of the puzzle together to form the big picture. I will go through some basic balloon twisting techniques below so you can start twisting!!

Use of Hand Pump

BLOW up the balloon using your hand pump, make sure you hold the balloon onto the **NOZZEL** of the pump when pumping so the balloon won't fly away. Leave a tail of about an index finger long at the end, this will give your balloon rooms for twisting. Then tie a knot at the mouth of the balloon to stop air from escaping.



The Bend & Stretch and Pinch & Twist

Grab the balloon with both hands, one on each side. Then **BEND** it like you're a strong man or woman. **STRETCH** it gently like an elastic band. **PINCH** the balloon like you pinch your little brother and sister, and **TWIST** it!
You have now made a balloon sausage!!!



Good job! You have learned the very basics of balloon twisting. Let's move on to some more basic techniques.



Basic Balloon Twists

There are 4 types of twists you should practice before making a balloon animal.

Pinch & twist (which you already know)



Find any where on the balloon, pinch it with your thumb and index finger and twist it 5 times.

Loop twist



Start at the knot end, bend a small part of the balloon down and around so it looks like an oval, pinch and twist the knot into the balloon.

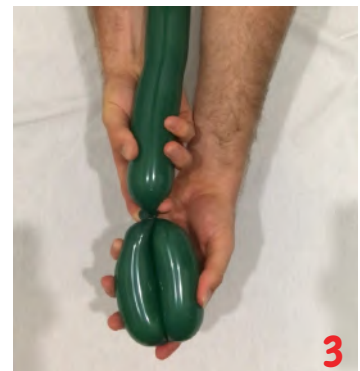
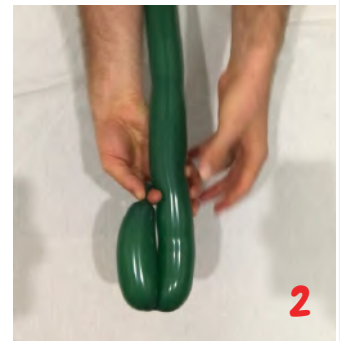
Lock twist

Make two of the same size bubbles, and twist the knot into the balloon. Very similar to loop twist except you have to pinch & twist first before bending it.

Ear twist



Make a bubble about the width of your palm and a 2cm bubble. Bend the big bubble down so both bubbles are touching each other. Grab the 2cm bubble with your other hand, then pull and twist.



Basic Balloon Animals Twisting

Balloon Dog

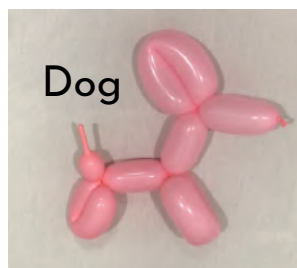
STEP 1 Pump up a 260Q balloon, leave a finger length tail at the end. Do a loop twist but instead twisting the knot into the balloon, pinch it half way and twist it 5 times. The bending part of the balloon should be about the size of your hand. You have now made the head and ears of your balloon dog. Well done!



STEP 2 To make the neck and front legs, measure a hand length down from the head and do a loop twist. Twist it 5 times to secure. Now you have a head, ears, neck and front legs!! Way to go!



STEP 3 Repeat Step 2 for the tail and back legs, it's exactly the same. After you have done a few practices on this, you can make other animals from this basic design by simply altering the length of the bubbles. If you want to learn more, visit my website to get your beginner balloon and juggling skills video tutorial.



Dog



Giraffe



Sausage dog

Are You Ready?

When you think you have finally mastered some of the tricks and come up with your own little show, you are ready to perform! Well, at least for families and friends.

Here are some extra accessories you might need for your show...

- Rope:

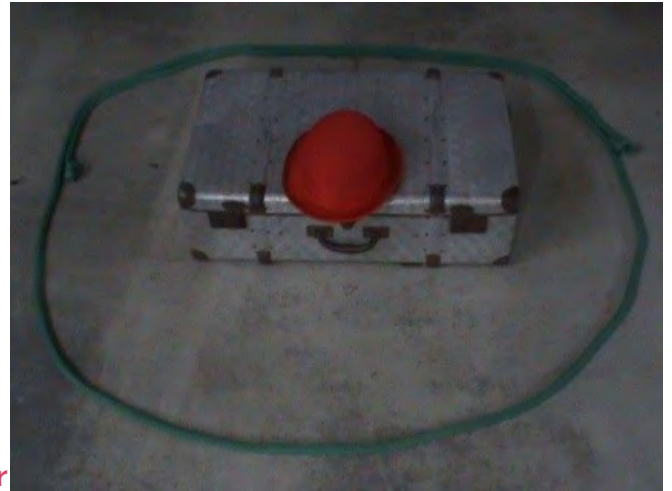
To outline your performing area or create a stage, so the audience knows not to enter your space and possibly get hurt if you are doing dangerous tricks.

- A bag or suitcase:

To store all your props and equipment, and keep your performing space clean and tidy.

- A colourful hat:

It helps to create your character and add colour to your costume. It can also be used to collect money if you are busking on the streets ;)



Now you have all the props, let's talk about the theme of your costumes and character.

Costumes & Character

Think of a character, **THEN** choose the costume.

Your character could be any one or and **THING!** Incorporate your props in your character development. For example, your character could be a "drummer in a marching band" while your juggling clubs were your "drumsticks". Then you start creating a show routine that evolves around this theme.

Or you can start off with any bright colourful circus clothes, just build up your confidence and then think about the theme of your costumes and character once you have done a few performances. Remember the 2 golden rules.

Look cute and start with a 5min routine!



Show Routine

VERY IMPORTANT...

Show Running Order

It doesn't matter if you are performing by yourself, with a friend, or with your brother or sister, always write down the running order and place it near your equipment.

Here is an example:

- Dance - 20 sec

It doesn't matter if you're not that good, it's only a starter/intro to your show.

- Introduction:

Create a show/stage name and announce it to everyone, then follow up with something like "*Thank you for coming and watching my show! We're going to have heaps of fun tonight!*"

- Repeat dance routine - 20 sec

- Ball juggling - 1 min

- Hoop: 1 min

- Club Juggling - 1 min

- Twirling Poi - 1 min



Adding music to your routine is great for creating a good atmosphere for audience and keep their energy going!

Always end your show by saying your name and thank you to the audience for watching your show. Your crowd will clap, cheers, even go crazy for you !!!



Good Luck out there

Have fun!

Don't be scared and take risks!!

Go spread laughter and joy to the world!!!

So that's it!

You never know, it might just change your life...Like it did for us!!

1 - GET READY & PRACTICE.

2 - GET SETTING UP YOUR ROUTINE..

3 - GET PERFORMING!!!!

Good luck everyone!!!!

If you have any questions, please email me at rhettbigstar@hotmail.com.

Thank you.

★RhettStar, The Variety Entertainer

See you next time !



Follow me on Social Media



Party tricks you can try

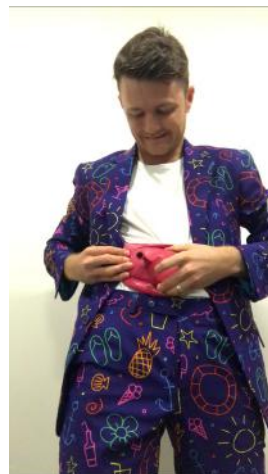
Twirling, Whirly Toothbrush

Grab your parent's old toothbrush and balance it on your index finger. Now start getting some momentum by twirling your finger toward yourself, with a little bit of re-adjusting and practice, you will be the life of the party!



Make your own POPular phone case

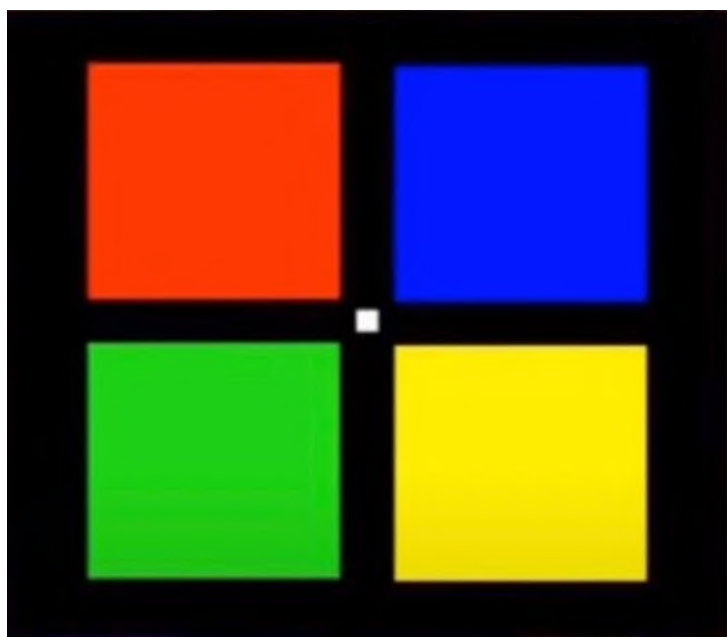
Find an old party balloon from your previous party, an iPhone or any smartphone of similar size or smaller. Blow the balloon all the way up, then place your phone on the other end of the balloon. Meanwhile, slowly release the air in the balloon and push the phone into the balloon. Hey presto! You have your own cool phone case! You will be the new POPular kid at school !!!



Bonus Eye Illusions

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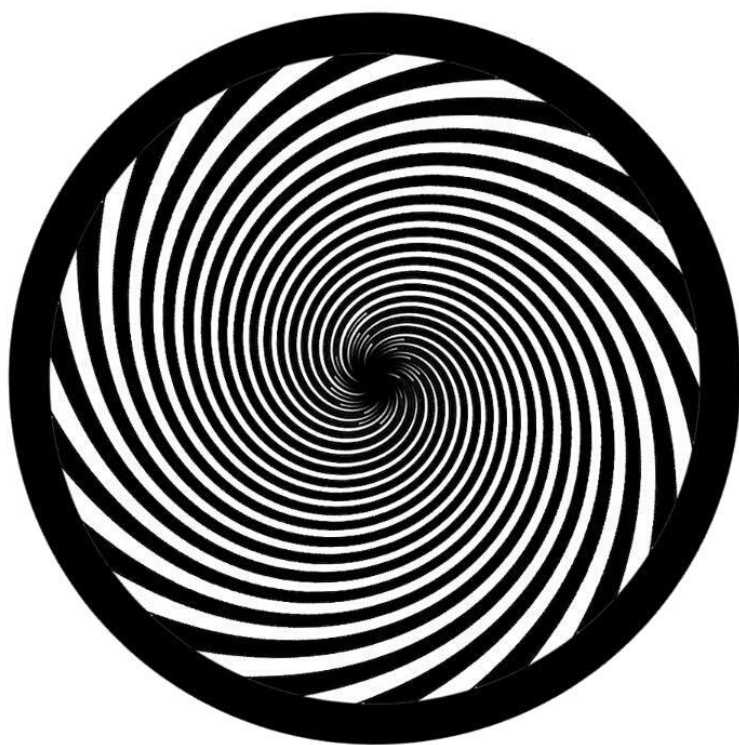
These Eye Illusions are awesome fun! Save the images to your computer and trick your family and friends!



All you have to do is focus on the white dot in the centre for 20 seconds.

Then quickly look at a white wall and blink rapidly until you see the same image on the wall.

Mind-blowing isn't it?



For this illusion, look up on Goggle or print the spiral out. Get a skewer and then pierce the centre of the spiral and get someone to spin the spiral at a medium pace. Stare into the centre for 30 seconds then look at the back of your hand.

Surprise! Your hand will start to move!!!

Reference

Eye Illusions - <https://faculty.washington.edu/chudler/after.html>



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